PromoFinder AI · finding promos in microdrama scripts

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Live app promofinder-rb4wbkeye8i8jttfu7ay67.streamlit.app

Code + run steps github.com/Harsh-2005-Bhati/promofinder

Raw outputs full 50-episode pack

80%	15 / 15	100%	18 s · ₹0
of the top 20 approved in review (up from 55% in v1)	key story moments found in each episode's shortlist	of 201 promos pass every timestamp & quality check	for all 50 episodes with rules AI judge ≈ ₹1–3 / episode

1 The problem, and why I picked it

PROBLEM FRAMING

- **The pain:** an editor watches every episode to pick promo moments, one show at a time, while Kuku releases new shows **every week**.
- **Why a tool fits:** a good promo follows checkable rules (hook in 3 s, cliffhanger at the cut, makes sense alone).
- **The scripts already timestamp every line**, so the risky part (exact cut points) can be exact code. AI is only used where taste is needed.
- **Scope:** find and rank 20–60 s clips with exact start/end times, ready for an editor. No editing or music, as the brief says.

2 Assumptions I made

PROBLEM FRAMING

- **Promos recruit new viewers, who start at episode 1.** So late reveals ("You're the Duke?") are **spoilers**, not good promos.
- Script timings match the video. Hook = first 3 s, cliffhanger = last 5 s, length strictly 20–60 s.
- One continuous clip by default, plus two-part **cold opens** (≤6 s teaser + main clip) from the same episode.
- **Kuku's scripts never went to a free-tier AI** (Google may use free inputs). AI was tested on a synthetic pack.
- Assumed volume: **10 shows a week**.

3 How it works: what is code, what is AI, where the human stays

APPROACH & SCALE

Read 50 scripts → Cut 16,167 candidate clips → Score with rules → AI judge (optional) → Validate every promo → Rank → Human approves → Editor pack

⚙ Code

Parses 3,727 lines, cuts clips only at line edges (**never mid-dialogue**), checks and ranks every promo (≤2 per episode in the top 20).

Timestamps must be exact, and they are already in the script. Free and instant.

☰ Rules

Score the hook, the cliffhanger (on the last *line*, so music can't fake it), standalone, density and **spoiler risk**.

Explainable, and a baseline that any AI must beat.

✦ AI (optional)

Re-scores the 5 best clips per episode and may move their edges, but only by returning **line numbers, never times**.

Judgement calls are where rules fail. Code re-checks every answer.

✔ Human

Approves or rejects each promo with a reason; the reasons feed a report that says **what to fix next**.

Taste stays with the team. Nothing is posted without approval.

4 What I would post first, and why

PROTOTYPE OUTPUT

	Clip	Opens on (first 3 s)	Cuts on	Why it works
1	**Ep 1** · 00:46.8–01:10.6 · 24 s	"You knew this before I walked through those doors!"	"And you knew?"	Altar betrayal: the whole premise in 24 s
2	**Ep 27** · 00:44.5–01:32.7 · 48 s	"What is your husband's name?" + doors pounding	"...knew better than every physician in this house?"	A secret about to come out, interrupted
3	**Ep 32** · 01:59.6–02:34.4 · 35 s	"Silence! Silence!"	Juliana gasps... the glowing iron thrusts forward	Highest stakes; the episode's own ending
4	**Ep 3** · 00:25.9–01:17.1 · 51 s	"You have humiliated this family enough for one day."	"And who are you to give orders in my family's chapel?!"	A mysterious stranger steps in
5	**Ep 21** · 00:11.2–00:35.8 · 25 s	"My little brother... cannot breathe!"	"...he will die! You are his only hope"	A ticking clock with a child's life

All five were approved in review, come from five different episodes and carry near-zero spoiler risk. Every promo also gets a one-line *why*, a clip sheet with timecodes, an **EDL for Premiere/Resolve** and ready-to-run **ffmpeg cut commands**, so an editor can use it directly.

5 How I know it's good, and where it fails

QUALITY CHECKING

Check (real runs on the full 50-episode pack)	v1 · first version	v2 · after review
Precision: top 20 approved / rejected with tagged reasons	11 / 20 (55%)	**16 / 20 (80%)**
Recall: key moment of 15 episodes (picked blind from the logline) in that episode's top 3 · top 5	13 / 15 · 15 / 15	11 / 15 · **15 / 15**
Validator: no cut mid-line · 20–60 s · a line in the first 3 s · quoted text really in the clip	196 / 196	**201 / 201 (+41 / 41 cold opens)**
Rules vs AI judge (Gemini 3.8 Flash, synthetic pack)	–	agree on 5 of the top 10; AI is stricter on hooks and context

How v1 became v2

- The 9 rejected clips fell into 4 patterns: spoilers · fake cliffhangers · mid-conversation openers · cut after the slap
- I turned each pattern into a rule, then reviewed the **12 new top-20 clips blind**: 8 approved, 4 rejected.
- Then I **froze the rules**, so I wasn't fitting them to my own labels.
- **Honest trade-off:** v2 is more precise but has fewer key moments in the top 3 (13 → 11). Partly that's right (it ends on the question and leaves the answer out); partly a regression, shown on the right.

Where it still picks badly (verbatim)

- **Needs context:** ep 32 opens on "Burn it." (burn *what*?)
- **Loud ≠ tense:** ep 29 ends on a lament, "I saved her! I healed her!"
- **Missed spoiler:** ep 43's "declared dead" exposition reached #20.
- **Regression:** the ep 39 finale ("...cuts sharply to black") scored 0 as a cliffhanger, because the line has no tense keyword.

> **Feedback loop:** the cliffhanger, context and spoiler scores now separate approved from rejected clips; the **hook score barely does** (0.91 vs 0.82), so hooks are the next fix.

6 Scale & cost

APPROACH & SCALE

Step	Per show	10 shows / week
Code + rules (parse → editor pack)	**≈18 s · ₹0**	**≈3 min · ₹0**
AI judge, Gemini 3.8 Flash paid ≈2,550 input tokens/episode (measured)	₹54–161	₹270–800 (Batch)
Human review of the top 20	≈15 min (my estimate)	≈2.5 h

- Only the AI step costs money; re-runs are free (cached).
- **Latency, not cost, is the limit:** batch or parallelise.
- If AI doesn't beat the rules on the team's labels, **keep the free rules**.

Google 2027 list price ($1.50 / $7.50 per 1M tokens), ₹95/$.

7 Runs on new input, with any model

PROTOTYPE

- Input: a **ZIP, a folder or single .txt episodes**, in the app or `python run_pipeline.py input.zip`
- Tested on **10 kinds of broken files** (uppercase, missing headers, renamed characters, HH:MM:SS times, truncated, garbage): it **warns and skips, never crashes**.
- **Model swap is one flag:** Gemini, Anthropic, OpenAI, Groq or **any OpenAI-compatible API**: `--llm custom --base-url URL --model NAME`
- Bad AI answer → retry → **fall back to rules**. Every AI answer is re-checked by code.
- **27 automated tests**; `evaluate.py`, `feedback.py`, `cost_estimate.py` reproduce every number here.

8 AI tools I used, and where they got it wrong

REQUIRED BY THE BRIEF

- **Claude (Claude Code):** helped me build and test the code, audit the scripts and draft the review decisions from each clip's full script, which I checked.
- **Gemini 3.8 Flash:** the optional AI judge.

> **Where it went wrong:** Gemini rejected three clips and proposed better ranges, but quoted lines from the *old* range. **My validator caught all three** ("text not in clip"). The cause was my prompt not saying which range to describe; it's fixed, with a regression test. This is why code checks every AI output instead of trusting it.

- Also: Claude's first cost estimate ("under ₹1 per episode") ignored billed thinking tokens (real: ₹1–3), and a rule matched "fire" inside "firewood", lifting a weak clip into the top 20 until review caught it.

9 Limits & what I'd do next

Limits: two review rounds of 20 (drafted with AI, checked by me), on one period-romance series. A blind review by the promo team is the real test.

1. Sit with the promo team; A/B top picks vs hand-picked promos on 3-s hold & click-through
2. Fix hooks and the ep 39 regression, then re-review
3. Run the AI judge on real scripts with a no-training key; keep it only if it beats the rules
4. Promos that join moments across episodes
5. Speech-to-text + shot detection for shows without timed scripts

> **Confidentiality:** no script files are published; the outputs quote only the single hook/ending line needed to review each clip.